

STAGE THREE • JOB APPLICATION & INTERVIEW SKILLS

FIRSTS

ADAPTATION NOTES

Online vs. in-person format notes for every activity that changes shape

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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PURPOSE

Stage Three's group activities are almost entirely performance-based — mock interviews, negotiation role-plays, presentation practice — which actually translate to video call formats reasonably well, since real interviews increasingly happen over video too. A few activities genuinely benefit from being run online for exactly this reason: practicing a mock interview over video is closer to many participants' actual upcoming interview format than an in-person version would be.

This document covers every activity across Stage Three's Session Plan and Group Versions of Key Exercises documents that genuinely changes shape between formats.

Format Notes by Activity

Activity	In-Person	Online
Strategy Swap (FIRST C2)	Pairs turn chairs to face each other for a direct conversation.	Breakout rooms of 2. Ask each pair to also drop their target role/company count in chat before the breakout, so the facilitator can spot outliers to check in on afterward.
Group Decode (FIRST C5)	Small groups huddle around a printed job listing or shared laptop.	Share the listing link in chat and use breakout rooms of 3-4 with a shared Google Doc for each group to record their must-haves list.
Round-Robin Storytelling (FIRST C6)	Small groups sit in a tight circle for direct, natural conversation.	Breakout rooms of 3-4. This works nearly as well online as in person since it's primarily about speaking and listening, not physical presence.
Rapid-Fire Practice (FIRST C7)	Pairs face each other; facilitator calls time verbally.	Breakout rooms of 2 with a visible shared countdown timer (screen share or a stated time check), since pairs can't hear a room-wide time cue.
Full Panel Simulation (FIRST C10)	Volunteer sits facing a small panel at the front of the room; rest of the group observes.	Panelists and the candidate keep cameras on; use "spotlight" on the candidate's video so their reactions are clearly visible to observers. Everyone else stays muted.
Negotiation Role-Play (FIRST C11)	Pairs face each other directly for a natural back-and-forth.	Breakout rooms of 2. Consider having each pair do a written chat negotiation first, then a verbal one — comparing how the tone differs between the two is itself a useful discussion point.
Small-Audience Delivery (FIRST C14)	Small groups sit facing the presenter, simulating a real small audience.	Breakout rooms of 3-4 with the presenter sharing their screen if using slides. Ask the audience to keep cameras on so the presenter gets real, visible reactions rather than presenting to blank tiles.
Outside Perspective Check (FIRST C20)	Pairs review printed or laptop-based comparison matrices side by side.	Breakout rooms of 2 with each person sharing their screen briefly to walk through their matrix before the discussion.
Full-group share-outs / closing rounds	Genuine round-robin around the room.	Use "raise hand" or call names directly from a list rather than open-floor, which tends to stall on video.

GENERAL HYBRID GUIDANCE

For the Full Panel Simulation (Mock Interview, C10) in a hybrid session, consider running the entire exercise on video even for in-person participants — have the candidate and panel use laptops with cameras on, since many real interviews for this cohort will happen this way, and consistency of format matters more here than physical presence.

For any breakout-based activity, remote participants should be grouped together rather than mixed with in-person clusters, since a mixed group leaves the remote person genuinely sidelined.